the inquisition. In a large room, I saw on the floor and shelves, many prohibited books, some of which were English: in another room, I saw multitudes of crosses, beads, and small pictures. The painted cap was also showed me, and the vestments for the unhappy victims. After several consultations, I was permitted to go up the private staircase, by which prisoners are brought to the tribunal; this leads to a passage with several doors in it, which I was not permitted to enter. On one of the secretaries telling me, "None but prisoners ever enter these rooms"; I answered, "I would be confined for a month to satisfy my curiosity." He replied, "None come out under three years, and they take the oath of secrecy." I learned, by walking in the court, and conversing with the inquisitors, that the cells have double doors, and are separated by two walls, to prevent prisoners conversing together, and that over the space between the walls there is a sort of chimney or funnel, enclosed at the top, but having perforations on the sides, through which some air and a glimmering of light enter. These funnels, the inquisitors told me, are double barred: and one of them serves two cells. Both the inquisitors assured me that they did not put irons on any of their prisoners. The passages into which some of the cells open, have small apertures for the admission of light. In a gloomy area at the back of the prison, there was nothing but a great mastiff dog.

It is well known that from this court there is no appeal. I need not say how horrid the secrecy and severity of it appear. I could not but observe, that even the sight of it struck terror into the common people as they passed. It is styled, by a monstrous abuse of words, the Holy and Apostolic Court of Inquisition.

PAMPLONA. The prison at Pamplona is an old building in the middle of the city. It has three small courts: the prisoners lie in boxes without mattresses or bedding. There were stocks, and also a dark vaulted room for the punishment of offences committed in the prison. The rooms being very dirty and offensive, I inquired whether epidemical distempers had not sometimes prevailed there, and was answered in the affirmative, and told that about eight years ago, eighteen or twenty prisoners had died in a short time. Here were sixty-one men and three women, 15 April, 1783. Allowance to each is about twopence a day.

The upper floor of this prison is used as a house of correction for women. I saw twenty-eight in four rooms, all spinning, but

not with wheels. Each had a bed; the rooms were clean. The bread was good; allowance one pound and a half a day. The term of confinement, from four years to eight; but if any person should choose to marry one confined for small offences, the magistrates are ready to release her. One of the magistrates told me that he visited this prison every week, to hear any complaints that might be made. I inquired whether the keeper went with him? He replied that he did.

The torture is not used in this province (Navarre). A singular custom prevails here; for twice in the year (the day before Christmas, and eight days before Easter), the Viceroy goes with the magistrates to the council-chamber in the prison, and releases whom he pleases of the prisoners. The day before I got to Pamplona, he had released thirteen. A few years ago, to the surprise of the magistrates, all were released.

FRENCH FLANDERS AND FRANCE

The French provinces in Flanders and the Netherlands, are chiefly governed by the same *arrêt de parlement* as the provinces in France.

LILLE. The Tour de St. Pierre at Lille is an old building. There were in it, 24 May, 1783, three debtors, five smugglers, and four vagrants. Five were sick in a very offensive room, with only one bed. Allowance is one pound and a half of bread. The small and dark dungeons down fifteen steps, I was glad to find unoccupied.

I have reason to be abundantly thankful for recovery from a fever which I caught of the sick, in this prison, at my last visit; and would make my grateful acknowledgment to that kind hand, by which I have been hitherto preserved.

At the city prison there were fourteen prisoners: their allowance consists of bread, butter, and small beer. The dungeons were empty.

The unhealthy countenances of the prisoners at the citadel show the pernicious effects of lying in caserns, or damp rooms under the fortifications. 26 May, 1783, here were three hundred and forty prisoners, most of them deserters. In the sick-rooms, which were very close and dirty, there were eighty-six; some of whom, though dying, were in irons. The scurvy has lately made great havoc here. Particular attention should be paid